

Analysis of Dark Ship-to-Ship Transfer Patterns in the Eastern Mediterranean

SAMPLE OSINT TRAINING REPORT | Portfolio Demonstration | Sep 2026
Prepared by: Mohanad Issa | Aspiring CTI & OSINT Analyst

DISCLAIMER: TRAINING REPORT / SAMPLE OSINT ANALYSIS - All data is simulated and based on public OSINT methodology for portfolio demonstration purposes only. No real vessels are accused.

Executive Summary & Objective

Objective: Analyze common tactics used for dark STS operations to evade sanctions in Eastern Mediterranean using OSINT methodology.

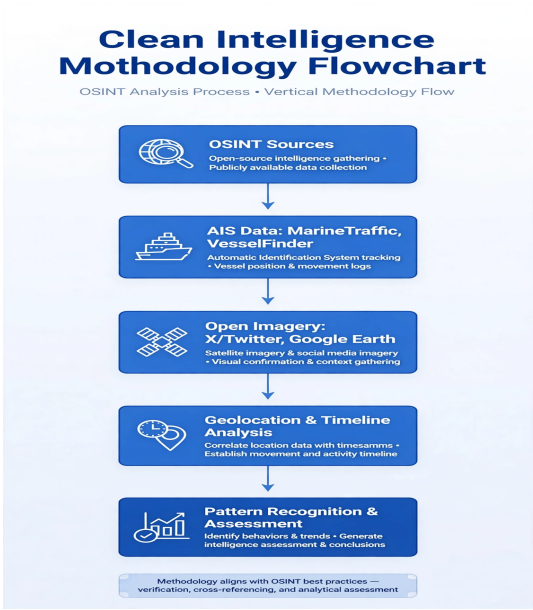
Key Finding: The most common pattern is AIS gap (48-72h) + proximity to sanctioned coastlines (Syria/Libya/Cyprus) + open-source imagery verification. Combination of AIS data + imagery is strongest indicator.

Classification: UNCLASSIFIED - Training Example | Confidence: N/A - Training Purposes



Figure 1: Known High-Risk Areas for Dark Activity in Eastern Med (Training Data) - Red dashed circles indicate high-risk zones identified for dark activity.

Methodology & OSINT Tradecraft



Tool	Purpose
MarineTraffic	Tracking vessel movements & AIS gaps
VesselFinder	Cross-referencing AIS data
Google Earth Pro	Geolocation verification
X Advanced Search	Open imagery discovery
MITRE ATT&CK	T1070 - Impair Defenses / Defense Evasion

Simulated Case Study - Illustrative Scenario (No Real Vessel)

Scenario: Tanker A enters region, exhibits 48h AIS gap near Cyprus, open-source image shows two vessels in proximity. This is a FICTIONAL example to demonstrate analytical process.

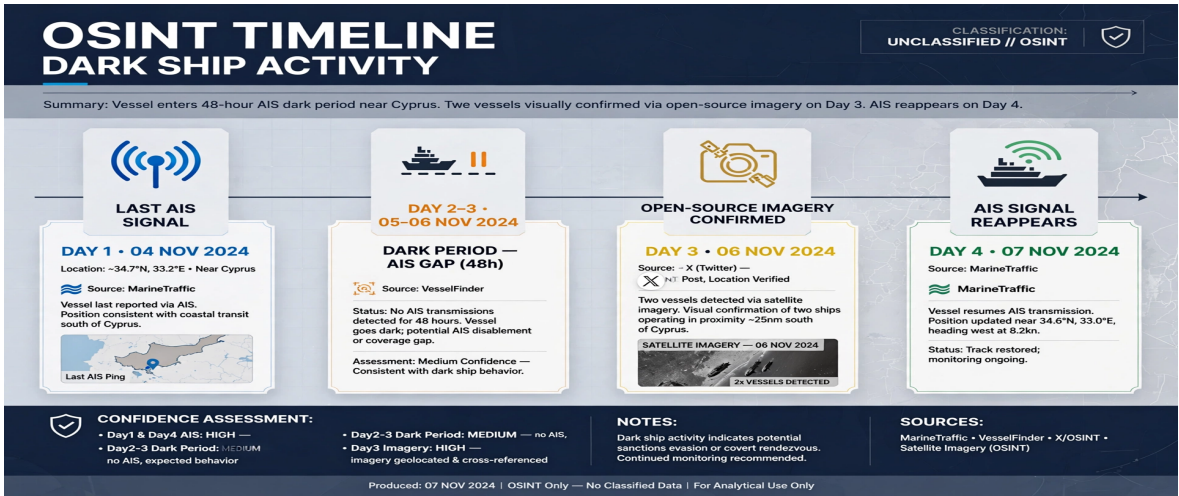


Figure 3: Simulated Timeline - Dark Period Analysis (Training Data)



Figure 4a: Illustrative Crude Oil Tanker - Training Example | Source: MarineTraffic © PHIL GIBSON / gibbo - Used as illustrative vessel type only, not related to any investigated pattern. Vessel identity redacted for training purposes. For demonstration of vessel type analysis only.

Key Indicators, Conclusion & Recommendations

Key Indicators of Dark STS:

1. Long AIS Gap (>24h) in high-risk zones
2. Proximity to sanctioned coastlines (Syria, Libya)
3. STS-capable vessels in same area
4. Imagery corroboration from open sources

Assessment: In a real investigation, these indicators would warrant further monitoring and escalation to compliance team.

Recommendations:

- Continuous monitoring of high-risk zones
- Automated AIS anomaly detection
- Analyst training on geolocation & verification
- Integration of satellite imagery + AIS

Skills Demonstrated: OSINT Collection & Verification | AIS Data Analysis (MarineTraffic, VesselFinder) | Geolocation & Timeline Analysis | MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping | Report Writing & Visualization | Critical Thinking & Pattern Recognition

Contact: Mohanad Issa | Aspiring CTI / OSINT Analyst | Certified: ArcX CTI 101, Basel OSINT, Google Cybersecurity | Ready for: SOC Analyst, Threat Intel Analyst, OSINT Analyst (Remote)

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